

STG17 LABORATORY · EXPLORE · MEASURE · CHOOSE

Beyond ChatGPT

*Ten AI tools still rarely used by statistics offices — tested
on real use cases*

Practical guide · step-by-step cards · ready-to-use prompts · quality checks

African Development Bank · African Union (STATAFRIC) · National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda



Perplexity



LeapSpace



NotebookLM



Data Commons



GLM · Z.ai



Kimi



Nano Banana



Flow



Jev



Le Chat

Three convictions behind this guide



The task first

Each tool is presented on a concrete office use case, in its place in the statistical business process (GSBPM).



Measure, don't marvel

Every trial ends with three measurements: time saved, verified quality, risk. Results feed a shared evidence base.



Govern from the start

Access, provider country, data allowed: shown on every card. Nothing confidential goes into an online tool.

10 tools · 6 families of use · 1 test method · all reachable from a browser, most of them free of charge.

Six steps, ten tools

01**Framing**

Tool map, access conditions, test method

02**Search and understand**

Perplexity · LeapSpace · NotebookLM · UN Data Commons

03**Turn reports into products**

GLM (Z.ai) · Kimi — from PDF to dashboard

04**Visualise and tell**

Nano Banana · Google Flow

05**Decide and protect**

Jev · Le Chat · golden rules

06**Roll out**

One-day scenario, lab logistics, evaluation

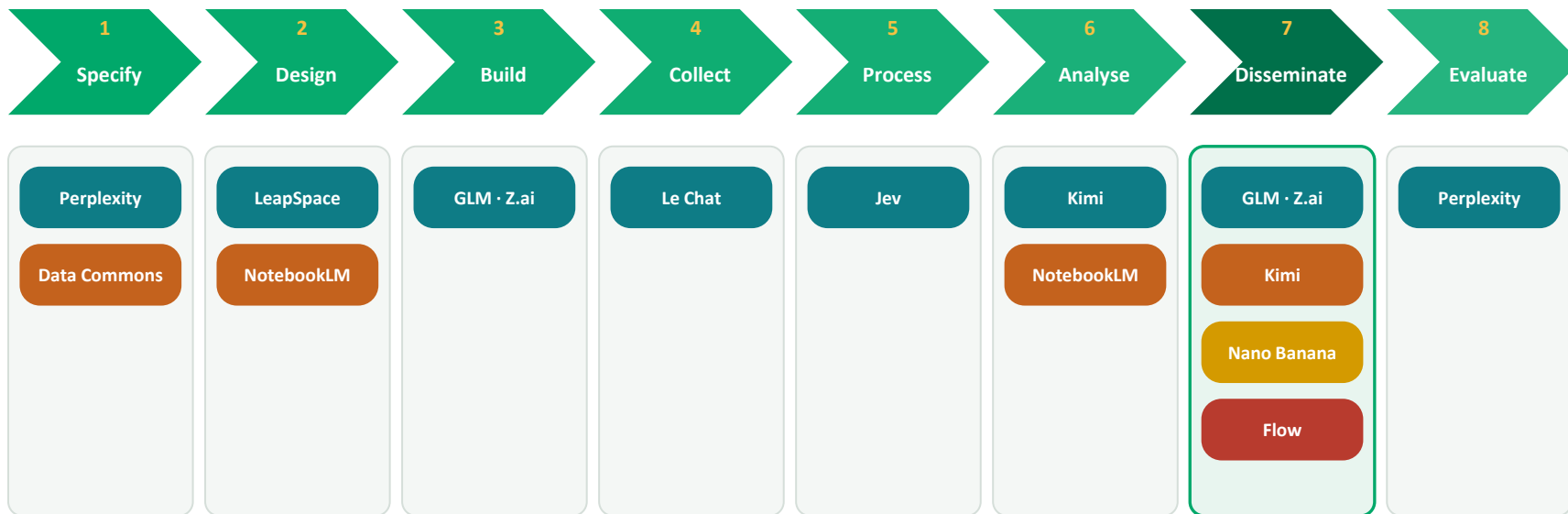
01

The right tool for the right task

What if ChatGPT were not the best tool for half of your tasks?



Ten tools across the statistical production chain



Key point: dissemination (phase 7) is where these tools change the most — reports turned into dashboards, infographics and videos.

Reference: UNECE, *Generic Statistical Business Process Model (GSBPM) v5.1*.

Access, provider country, data allowed

Tool	Provider · country	Access	Data allowed
Perplexity	Perplexity AI · United States	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only
LeapSpace	Elsevier · Netherlands / UK	INSTITUTIONAL	Public or synthetic only
NotebookLM	Google · United States	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only
UN Data Commons	UN + Google	FREE	Public UN statistics
GLM (chat.z.ai)	Z.ai · China	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only
Kimi (OK Computer)	Moonshot AI · China	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only
Nano Banana	Google (Gemini app)	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only
Google Flow	Google · United States	SUBSCRIPTION	Public or synthetic only
Jev	TypeSafe AI · United States	EARLY ACCESS	Public or synthetic only
Le Chat	Mistral AI · France (EU)	FREE · LIMITS	Public or synthetic only

Conditions verified in September 2026; they change often — confirm on the day of the lab.

Quick access: scan to open each tool



Perplexity

www.perplexity.ai



LeapSpace

elsevier.com/.../leapspace



NotebookLM

notebooklm.google.com



UN Data Commons

data.un.org



GLM · Z.ai

chat.z.ai



Kimi

www.kimi.ai/



Nano Banana (Gemini)

gemini.google.com



Google Flow

labs.google/fx/tools/flow



Jev (TypeSafe)

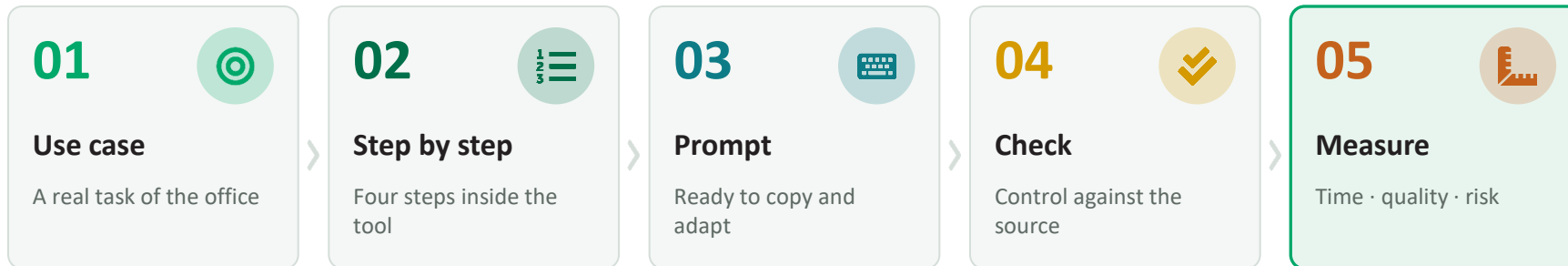
console.typesafe.ai



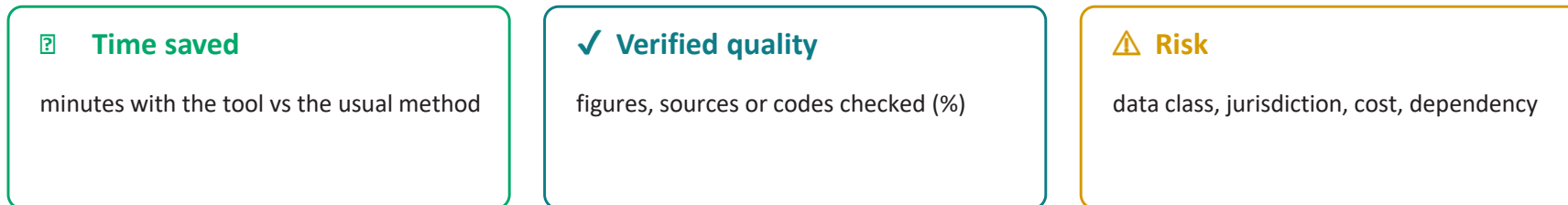
Le Chat (Mistral)

chat.mistral.ai

One common test method for the ten tools



THE THREE MEASUREMENTS OF EVERY TRIAL



SECTION 02 · SEARCH & UNDERSTAND

02

Search and understand

Find the right source, rather than a plausible answer.



Perplexity — sourced horizon scanning and benchmarking

**Perplexity**

Perplexity AI · web search with citations

www.perplexity.ai

FREE · LIMITS



NSO USE CASE

Find out in 10 minutes how other offices publish an indicator, run a digital census or use mobile phone data.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Research how African national statistics offices publish regional inflation (2023–2026). For each country: method, frequency, link to the OFFICIAL publication. Present a table. Write "not found" rather than guessing.



Check: open every link; count the share of official sources (NSO sites, UN, IMF). Aim for 100% for an internal note.



A fluent answer may rest on an old or secondary page. Always check the date of the source.

- 1 Open perplexity.ai (a free account is advisable)
- 2 Ask the question, stating countries, period and type of source
- 3 Open every cited source; discard blogs and unofficial pages
- 4 Export the answer and the links into your scanning note

LeapSpace — methodological literature review

**LeapSpace**

Elsevier · peer-reviewed scientific literature

elsevier.com/products/leapspace

INSTITUTIONAL



NSO USE CASE

Before changing a method (imputation, small area estimation, satellite data), find out what the peer-reviewed literature says.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Which small area estimation methods are recommended for district-level poverty using household surveys and satellite data? Compare them (bias, precision, data requirements) and cite studies published since 2018, stating their limitations.



Check: open the 3 most-cited papers and check that the reported conclusion really appears in the abstract or the text.



Institutional access: check before the lab whether your university, the AfDB or a partner subscribes.

- 1 Sign in through your institution or the free trial
- 2 Ask the precise methodological question
- 3 Read the Trust Cards: sources and why each is cited
- 4 Keep 3 to 5 key papers and their level of evidence

LeapSpace draws only on peer-reviewed content (Scopus, ScienceDirect) and attaches a Trust Card to every answer.

NotebookLM — your documents become an assistant

**NotebookLM**
Google · grounded in your sources
notebooklm.google.com

FREE · LIMITS



NSO USE CASE

Turn the office's methodological notes and published reports into a knowledge base: sourced answers, infographic, slide deck, audio or video summary.

- 1 Create a notebook, add 3 to 5 PUBLISHED documents
- 2 Ask 3 questions; click every citation
- 3 Studio: generate an infographic, a deck (PPTX export) or a video
- 4 Re-read the output against the sources; label it “AI-generated”

Studio: audio and video overviews, mind maps, reports, infographics, slide decks and data tables; decks export to PPTX.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

```
Using ONLY the sources: summarise the CPI methodology in 5 points for journalists. Cite the source for each point. State explicitly what the sources do not cover.  
[Studio -> Infographic: institutional style]
```



Check: does every citation point to the right passage? Are the figures in the infographic identical to the report?



Generated images (infographics, slides) can distort a figure: re-read them one by one.

UN Data Commons — the UN in plain language



UN Data Commons
UN + Google · since 17/09/2026
data.un.org

FREE



NSO USE CASE

See how YOUR country's figures appear in UN databases, compare them with your national publications and spot the gaps to fix.

- 1 Open data.un.org
- 2 Ask a plain-language question about your country
- 3 Compare every value with the national publication
- 4 Note the gaps: definition, year, source, revision

UN platform built on Google's Data Commons, with natural-language search and the MCP protocol for AI agents; it replaces the former UNData portal.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Poverty rate, access to electricity and primary school enrolment in Rwanda, Senegal and Kenya since 2015

[then: open each chart -> source and year of every value]



Check: for 5 values of your country, is the gap with the national publication zero? If not, why (definition, vintage)?



Access to official data does not mean a correct answer: definitions and years may differ from yours.

SECTION 03 · TURN REPORTS INTO PRODUCTS

03

Turn reports into products

What if every PDF report became an interactive dashboard within an hour?



GLM (Z.ai) — from PDF report to dashboard



GLM-5.3
Z.ai · Agent / Full-Stack mode
chat.z.ai

FREE · LIMITS



NSO USE CASE

Turn a published release or statistical report into an attractive one-page web dashboard that the dissemination team can review and publish.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Build a ONE-page HTML dashboard from the attached report. Use ONLY its figures; under each figure show the source page. 3 key indicators, 4 charts, one downloadable table. Palette green #00704A and gold #F5C242, readable on mobile, WCAG AA contrast. A single self-contained HTML file. No invented figures: write [MISSING] if data is absent.



Check: pick 10 figures from the dashboard at random and find them on the report page indicated. Target: 10/10.



Provider established in China: published reports only. The generated code must be reviewed before going online.

- 1 Open chat.z.ai, switch on Agent (or Full-Stack) mode
- 2 Attach the published PDF report and paste the prompt
- 3 Preview, then ask for 2 rounds of layout changes
- 4 Download the HTML file; run the verification

In Agent mode GLM creates documents, analyses, websites and slides; GLM-5.3 offers a one-million-token context window.

Kimi (OK Computer) — the alternative to compare



Kimi
Moonshot AI · OK Computer agent mode
www.kimi.ai/

FREE · LIMITS



NSO USE CASE

Same task as GLM, on the same report: compare two agents to pick the one that suits the dissemination team.

- 1 Open kimi.ai, choose Agent mode (OK Computer)
- 2 Attach the SAME report, paste the SAME prompt
- 3 Download the result (site or slides)
- 4 Score both results with the same grid

OK Computer creates multi-page sites and editable slides, and handles up to a million rows of data.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

[Same prompt as for GLM]

Comparison grid, scored 1 to 5:
accuracy of the 10 sampled figures
readability and design
house style respected
accessibility (contrast, mobile)
total time, iterations included



Check: same sample of 10 figures as for GLM; compare the two scores and the times.



Provider established in China. Both agents may “embellish”: delete any chart without a source figure.

Six checks before publishing a dashboard



Figures

10 randomly drawn figures found on the source page



Sources

every chart states its source and year



Nothing invented

no “sample” chart, no data absent from the report



Accessibility

sufficient contrast, readable on a phone, alt text



Code

self-contained file; external scripts reviewed by IT



Sign-off

a line reading “produced with AI, approved by ...” and the date

SECTION 04 · VISUALISE & TELL

04

Visualise and tell

One accurate infographic beats ten pages nobody reads.



Nano Banana — infographics and visuals



Nano Banana
Google · inside the Gemini app
gemini.google.com

FREE · LIMITS



NSO USE CASE

Produce the visual card of a release (three key figures), a bulletin cover or a consistent series of social-media visuals.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Create a square infographic, sober institutional style, for a statistical release:
"Inflation 2025: 5.8% (from 6.7% in 2024)"
"Highest: Highlands, 8.2%"
"Lowest: Capital, 4.6%"
Palette green #00704A, gold #F5C242, white background. Simple pictograms. No other figures.



Check: compare every figure and every word in the image with the release. A single mistake = regenerate.



No real people, logos, flags or emblems. Label the image "AI-generated".

- 1 Open gemini.google.com and ask for an image
- 2 Paste the VERIFIED figures and the house style
- 3 Refine through conversation (colours, text, framing)
- 4 Proof-read every figure and every word in the image

Google Flow — a release teaser video



Google Flow

Google · video studio (Veo, Nano Banana)

labs.google/fx/tools/flow

SUBSCRIPTION



NSO USE CASE

Make an 8 to 15 second teaser announcing a release (census, survey) for social media — with no figures inside the video.

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Slow aerial shot at sunrise over green rolling hills and an East African village, golden light, documentary style, no text and no identifiable person. 8 seconds.

[Title and figures added afterwards in editing, from the verified release]

✓ **Check:** no figure or text generated inside the image; titles added in editing from the release.



Google AI subscription (Plus at least), age 18 and an eligible region. No real faces, no misleading scenes.

- 1 Facilitator demonstration (Google AI subscription required)
- 2 Create 2 to 3 key images with Nano Banana inside Flow
- 3 Animate them (Veo), assemble in SceneBuilder
- 4 Add title and figures in editing, not in generation

Flow requires a Google AI Plus, Pro or Ultra subscription, a minimum age of 18 and an eligible region; Veo videos carry an invisible SynthID watermark.

05

Decide and protect

When do you need a reliable decision rather than fine prose?



Jev — a decision model, not a chatbot

**Jev**

TypeSafe AI · choices, scores and probabilities

console.typesafe.ai

EARLY ACCESS



NSO USE CASE

Code free-text answers (occupation, industry, reason), route user requests or flag anomalies — with usable confidence.

- 1 Official TypeSafe console: Playground (early access)
- 2 Declare the question and the possible choices (e.g. 10 ISCO major groups)
- 3 Submit 24 answers whose code is known
- 4 Compare accuracy AND confidence with those of an LLM

PROMPT — READY TO COPY

Question: ISCO-08 major group of the occupation
Choices: 0 Armed forces ... 9 Elementary occupations (10 choices)
Context: "tea picker paid by the day"

Expected: one choice + a probability per choice
+ a confidence level



Check: on the 24 reference answers: accuracy, and the share of errors flagged by low confidence.



Speed and price figures are the provider's own: verify them on your cases. Synthetic data only.

Jev returns predefined choices, scores and probabilities with a confidence estimate rather than text; API early access since 17/09/2026.

Sovereignty: where does the data go?

United States

Perplexity · NotebookLM · Nano Banana · Flow · Jev ·
Data Commons (Google)

China

GLM (Z.ai) · Kimi (Moonshot AI)

European Union

Le Chat (Mistral AI, France) · LeapSpace (Elsevier)



The decisive lever: open weights

GLM, Kimi and Mistral publish open-weight models. Installed on an office server, they process sensitive data without it ever leaving the building. This is an infrastructure project, to be run with the IT department.



Le Chat (Mistral): the free European alternative, very strong in French. Useful for drafting and translation, under the same data rules. chat.mistral.ai



Four golden rules, valid for all ten tools

1**Public or synthetic data**

Never microdata, identifiers, embargoed figures or sensitive internal documents.

2**Back to the source**

Every figure, citation or code produced by a tool is checked against the original document.

3**Label the AI**

Images, videos, audio and dashboards carry the line “produced with AI, approved by ...”.

4**One account per person**

No shared account; no password or key in a document or a cell.

The right tool, properly checked, serving official statistics

1

The task picks the tool

Search, understand, transform, visualise,
decide: each use has its own tool.

2

Measure before adopting

Time, verified quality, risk: three
numbers for every trial, shared between
countries.

3

The source has the last word

Public data, back to the source,
generated content labelled, one account
per person.

Over to you: choose two cards, test, measure — and share your results.

Country	Data Source	PDF Status	Language	Link
Botswana	Statistics Botswana	PDF indexed	EN	statsbots.org.bw > CPI January 2026.pdf
Burundi	INSBU	PDF indexed · 2025 edition	FR	insbu.bi > IPC-Fevrier-2025.pdf
Côte d'Ivoire	ANStat	Page · PDF to download	FR	anstat.ci > HCPI February 2026
Egypt	CBE · CAPMAS data	PDF indexed · central bank	EN	cbe.org.eg > inf_feb_2026_en.pdf
Ethiopia	ESS	Page opened · Download button	EN	ess.gov.et > CPI February 2026
The Gambia	GBoS	Page · no CPI PDF found	EN	gbosdata.org > Downloads
Ghana	GSS	Page opened · dynamic PDF link	EN	statsghana.gov.gh > inflation-rate
Kenya	KNBS	PDF indexed	EN	knbs.or.ke > ...February-2026.pdf

● Page, other format or older edition

Country	Data Source	Status	Language	Report Description	Link
Madagascar	INSTAT	Page	FR	New price index (NIPC) — January 2026, Excel data	instat.mg › NIPC January 2026
Morocco	HCP	DOCX	FR	CPI note — July 2026 (Word format)	hcp.ma › IPC Juillet 2026 Fr.docx
Nigeria	NBS	Page	EN	CPI Reports 2026 — monthly archives (ZIP)	microdata.nigerianstat.gov.ng › 154
Rwanda	NISR	PDF	EN	Consumer Price Index Report — July 2026	statistics.gov.rw › CPI July 2026 Report.pdf
Senegal	ANSD	PDF	FR	Harmonised CPI (HCPI) — Dec. 2025	ansd.sn › IHPC_base2023_DEC-25.pdf
Somalia	SNBS	PDF	EN	Somalia's Inflation Outlook — policy brief, March 2026	nbs.gov.so › Somalias-Inflation-Outlook.pdf
Tanzania	NBS	PDF	EN	National Consumer Price Index — February 2026	nbs.go.tz › CPI Release_022026_English.pdf
Zimbabwe	ZIMSTAT	PDF	EN	Consumer Price Index (ZWG) — December 2025	zimstat.co.zw › CPI_ZWG_12_2025.pdf

● Page, other format or older edition

Sources and verification points

Method

UNECE (2019). Generic Statistical Business Process Model, GSBPM v5.1.

LeapSpace

Elsevier (Nov. 2025, rollout 2026). LeapSpace, research-grade AI workspace. elsevier.com/products/leapspace

NotebookLM

Google. Studio: infographics, slide decks (PPTX export), videos. NotebookLM Help; press coverage 2026.

UN Data Commons

UN and Google (17 Sept. 2026). UN System Data Commons. data.un.org · blog.google

GLM · Z.ai

Z.ai. GLM-5 to 5.3 models, Agent mode on chat.z.ai. docs.z.ai

Kimi

Moonshot AI. OK Computer agent mode, K2.6 to K3 models. kimi.ai

Google Flow

Google Flow Help (2026): access conditions (Google AI subscription, age 18, regions).

Jev

TypeSafe AI (Sept. 2026). “System One” decision model; specialist press coverage.

Style: AfDB-inspired institutional palette — not the official brand manual.